CA/Browser Forum Tracker

What Changed, 15 to 18 October 2026

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About This Report

This is an experimental, AI-driven research project from SRL. SRL is independent, with no outside funding and no sponsors. It uses several AI models from competing labs, running on different platforms. One model gathers the current claims on a topic, a different one checks each claim against its source, and disagreements are kept, not smoothed over. The aim is an even-handed account that no outside party has shaped. AI makes mistakes, and so does the system built around it. We find and fix some in every cycle, so the methods keep changing and the content should improve over time. Updates come at least quarterly, sooner if something major happens.

This update covers the CA/Browser Forum and the browser root programs from 15 October to 18 October 2026. It follows the 15 October update. The period is three days long, and the report covers only what moved.

Section 1 names the change that matters most. Section 2 follows the Forum's ballots, none of which changed stage. Section 3 covers the root programs and the incident record. Section 4 covers transparency logs and the standards underneath. Section 5 closes with the picture as it stood on 15 October.

1. What Matters Most

One certificate authority's paperwork problem became the largest revocation of the month, and it is the only change here that reaches ordinary websites.

GoDaddy is revoking 404,607 certificates [1]. It opened the incident on 15 October, after finding that the policy information in certificates from its GoDaddy and Starfield hierarchies did not match its own certificate practice statement [1]. The mismatch covers the authority's policy identifiers and the address of its practice statement inside each certificate [1].

The deadline for those revocations is 18 October at 23:45 UTC [2]. GoDaddy said on 16 October that it does not expect to meet it, and filed the delay as a separate incident [2]. It said it began contacting subscribers on 14 October, including those holding many certificates, and that it will report progress on 19 October [2].

The incident grew out of GoDaddy's application to the Mozilla root store. The 15 October update reported that GoDaddy had confirmed the mismatch on that application and promised an incident report [3]. The report is this revocation. The application is still waiting for approval [3].

2. The Forum's Ballots

A ballot passes through discussion, a seven-day vote, a thirty-day intellectual property review and publication, and only the last step makes it a rule.

Current State

No ballot changed stage in the three days. Every open deadline falls after 18 October. SC105, which removes the High Risk Certificate Request language from the Baseline Requirements and the Extended Validation Guidelines, stays in discussion until 21 October [4]. Nobody has replied to it, and its voting dates are not set [4].

Two votes are open. SMC020, on recording the version of a validation method in S/MIME, closes on 19 October [5]. Its thread has grown to 21 messages, but the public mirror shows only the first eight, so the readable votes are still the four in favour from 13 October [5]. CSC-034, on how a natural person’s organization name appears in a code signing certificate, closes on 21 October [6]. Certum voted in favour on 16 October, joining HARICA and eMudhra, and no one has voted against [6].

The stalled items have not moved. SC-107, on certificate problem reports, is still in discussion two and a half weeks after its scheduled end, with no vote called [7]. SC-106, the ML-DSA ballot, has had no change to its draft since 31 August [8]. Its hand-over from Google Trust Services to Amazon Trust Services has not yet produced a new draft [8].

The adopted ballot NS-010 version 2 remains in intellectual property review until 13 November [9]. The working group’s ballots page still lists it as voting [9]. The Baseline Requirements stay at version 2.3.1, and the Forum’s repository still has no release tag for it [10] [11].

Recent Developments

A new proposal reached the server certificate list on 16 October, outside any ballot. It would require an authority to revoke a certificate on an actionable notice that the subscriber appears on a terrorism, sanctions or war crimes list [12]. Its author named the United States Treasury’s terrorism and criminal-organization sanctions programmes, the European Union terrorist list, the United Nations Security Council list and International Criminal Court warrants [12].

The first replies were sceptical. Rich Salz asked who would maintain such a list, and Santosh Pandit wrote that the Baseline Requirements are not the place for it [12]. Pandit pointed instead to the denied-list check that the Extended Validation Guidelines already contain [12]. The proposal leans on the High Risk language that SC105 would delete, so the two discussions touch [12] [4].

3. Root Programs and Incidents

The root programs decide who is trusted, and their public bug tracker is where every failure to follow the rules is recorded.

Recent Developments

Ten compliance bugs were opened between the evening of 15 October and the evening of 16 October, and none on 17 or 18 October [13]. Two are GoDaddy’s revocation and its late revocation [13]. Two more concern certificate profiles that did not match the rules, at eMudhra and ACCV, and two concern practice statement documents, at Telekom and eMudhra [13].

The other four were filed together on 16 October by one member of the public, not by a root program [13]. Each says that an authority's audit statement arrived between 108 and 144 days late without the required explanation. The authorities named are ITI Brazil, MULTICERT, Consorci AOC and Entrust [13]. None of the four has yet been confirmed by a root program [13].

Chrome adjusted the testing rules for its quantum-resistant root program on 16 October [14]. New requests to act as a cosigner must now follow revision 07 of the IETF Merkle Tree Certificate draft [14]. Chrome will keep revision 05 working for a while and drops revision 06 [14]. Its root policy and the program's draft policy are otherwise unchanged [14].

Current State

No root program took a distrust or removal action, and Mozilla's public policy list has had no posts since 8 October [15]. Apple made its first change to its root program repository since August, but only to the questionnaire for subordinate authorities operated by other companies [16]. Apple's draft Merkle Tree Certificate policy, promised by the end of October, has still not appeared [16].

The other applications are where they were. IdenTrust's public discussion of nine roots runs until 20 November, and the list has had no posts on it since 9 October [17].

4. Transparency and Standards

Every public certificate must appear in transparency logs whose operators are held to a standard, and the Forum's documents cite IETF standards that are still settling.

Recent Developments

Chrome's transparency log list moved to version 95.3 on 17 October, but no log changed state [18]. A new report on the transparency policy list says three TrustAsia logs return at most 32 entries per request and reject clients without saying when to retry [19]. HARICA's Selene logs, which missed their merge deadlines the week before, are still qualified [18].

Current State

The composite signature draft, which pairs ML-DSA with a conventional algorithm in one certificate, is still in final review at the RFC Production Center and has no RFC number [20]. The two TLS drafts for ML-KEM and ML-DSA are still waiting for an editor [21]. The LAMPS working group posted new revisions of its attestation drafts on 17 October and moved the composite key encapsulation profile for signed messages into the RFC Editor queue [20].

5. Where Things Stood on 15 October

The 15 October update told the longer story, and this section recalls enough of it to read this one.

On 15 October the Baseline Requirements had just reached version 2.3.1 through SC104, and NS-010 version 2 had finally been adopted. SMC020 and CSC-034 had entered their votes, and SC105 had opened its discussion. SC-107 was already overdue for a vote.

New officers had been confirmed to take over the Forum and its working groups on 1 December. Let’s Encrypt had announced that its default certificate lifetime would fall to 64 days from February 2027. Thirty-eight compliance bugs had been filed in eleven days, many of them about status services.

GoDaddy had just admitted that its certificate profiles did not match its practice statement and paused issuance under them. Chrome’s log list stood at version 95.1, and HARICA’s new logs had stumbled twice. The composite signature draft had just reached final review.

Sources

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